Himaayah Schools
TEENAGERS BUILDING CIRCLE

GUIDE

رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِّن لِّسَانِي يَفْقَهُوا قَوْلِي

"My Lord, expand my chest, ease my task and untie the knot in my tongue so they understand my speech."
(Ṭā Hā 20:25–28)

Month 5

Speaking with Confidence

Listen well, speak clearly, present with calm. A guide for students for each live session this month.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Month 5: Speaking with Confidence

Clear speech opens doors in study, work and da‘wah. This month you build the skills of listening, structuring ideas, using your voice, and speaking in front of others.

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> **“My Lord, expand my chest, ease my task and untie the knot in my tongue so they understand my speech.”**
>
> Ṭā Hā 20:25–28

How to use this guide

1. **Before each session**, read that session’s short teaching below. It takes two minutes.
2. **During the session**, take notes on the lines provided and write one question to ask.
3. **After the session**, do the “Try it” action within two days.
4. **Every day**, tick your habit tracker. **Every Sunday**, spend five minutes reviewing the week.
5. **At the end of the month**, complete the Month Review and show it to a parent or your facilitator.

This month at a glance

Week	Deen	Educational Development	Skills	Personal Development
Week 1 Foundations	Speak good or stay silent	Listening is half of speaking	Structure: open, three points, close	Nerves are normal
Week 2 Voice and body	Guarding the tongue	Answering in class	Voice, pace, pauses	Breathe before you speak
Week 3 Stories and persuasion	The Prophet's way of speaking	Writing a short speech	Tell a story that sticks	Confidence by doing
Week 4 Practice	A short naṣīḥah	Presenting what you studied	Give a three-minute talk	Receiving feedback

The month's challenge

Give three short talks in the month: one to your family, one in a session and one to a friend, and ask for feedback each time.

Week 1 Foundations

Deen: Speak good or stay silent

The Prophet ﷺ said whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day should speak good or keep silent (al-Bukhārī 6018, Muslim 47). Words are a trust to be weighed before they are spoken.

Try it this week

Before you speak in a conversation this week, ask: is it true, is it kind, is it useful?

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Listening is half of speaking

Good speakers listen first. Listening means looking at the speaker, not planning your answer, and asking a question to check you understood.

Try it this week

In one conversation, repeat back what you heard before you reply.

My notes and questions

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Skills: Structure: open, three points, close

A talk people remember has a clear opening, no more than three main points and a strong closing line.

Try it this week

Plan a one-minute talk on a topic you like using that structure.

My notes and questions

Personal Development: Nerves are normal

Feeling nervous means you care. Fear shrinks when you prepare, breathe and start small.

Try it this week

Name what you fear most about speaking. Write one step that would make it smaller.

My notes and questions

Week 2 Voice and body

Deen: Guarding the tongue

Allah forbids backbiting (al-Ḥujurāt 49:12). A confident speaker is one whose words build people up.

Try it this week

Spend one day without speaking ill of anyone, present or absent.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Answering in class

A clear answer states the point, gives a reason, adds an example and repeats the point. This is the PREP method.

Try it this week

Answer a question using Point, Reason, Example, Point, aloud, to a mirror or a friend.

My notes and questions

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Week 2: Voice and body (continued)

Skills: Voice, pace, pauses

Speak slightly slower than normal, vary your tone and use pauses. A pause feels long to you but strong to the listener.

Try it this week

Record yourself reading a paragraph. Listen and note one change in pace or tone.

My notes and questions

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Personal Development: Breathe before you speak

Slow breathing calms the body. Two deep breaths before you start steady your voice.

Try it this week

Before your next time speaking aloud, take two slow breaths and relax your shoulders.

My notes and questions

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Week 3 Stories and persuasion

Deen: The Prophet's way of speaking

ʿĀʾishah said the Prophet ﷺ spoke so clearly and slowly that anyone listening could count his words (al-Bukhārī 3567). Clear and unhurried speech is a sunnah.

Try it this week

Practise speaking more slowly and clearly in your next conversation.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Writing a short speech

A written speech uses short sentences and simple words. Read it aloud and cut anything that is hard to say.

Try it this week

Write a 150-word speech on a topic you care about. Read it aloud and edit it.

My notes and questions

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Week 3: Stories and persuasion (continued)

Skills: Tell a story that sticks

A story has a person, a problem and a change. It makes a point memorable.

Try it this week

Prepare a one-minute true story that makes a point and tell it to someone.

My notes and questions

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Personal Development: Confidence by doing

Confidence is not a feeling you wait for; it is built by doing the thing in small steps.

Try it this week

Speak up once in each session this week, even if it is only one sentence.

My notes and questions

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Week 4 Practice

Deen: A short naṣīḥah

Giving sincere advice is part of the religion. A short reminder, given gently and in private where possible, can change a heart.

Try it this week

Prepare a two-minute reminder on a topic from this month to share with family.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Presenting what you studied

Presenting a topic proves you understand it. Use a few key words, not full sentences, on your notes.

Try it this week

Present one topic from your studies in three minutes using only key-word notes.

My notes and questions

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Week 4: Practice (continued)

Skills: Give a three-minute talk

Combine everything: structure, voice, story and calm. Ask your listener for one thing you did well and one thing to improve.

Try it this week

Give a three-minute talk to your family or the Circle and ask for feedback.

My notes and questions

Personal Development: Receiving feedback

Feedback is information, not an insult. Listen, thank the person, and choose one thing to change.

Try it this week

After your talk, write down one piece of feedback and how you will use it.

My notes and questions

Daily habit tracker

Tick each box when you have done it. Be honest: the tracker is for you.

Week 1

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 2

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 3

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 4

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Month review

Rate yourself honestly from 1 (needs support) to 5 (excelling), then write one win and one thing to improve.

Pillar	Rating (circle one)	One thing I did well	One thing to improve
Deen	1 2 3 4 5		
Educational Development	1 2 3 4 5		
Skills	1 2 3 4 5		
Personal Development	1 2 3 4 5		

My biggest win this month

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What was hardest, and why

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What I will do next month

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Facilitator's comment

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Parent's comment

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A page for parents

Give your teenager a few minutes at dinner to share something they learned, without interruption. Praise clarity and effort, not perfection.

- **What the monthly report shows.** Your teenager's facilitator sends a report each month with attendance, a rating for each of the four pillars, assignments handed in and a personal note.
- **Three questions to ask this month.** What did you learn that surprised you? Which session helped you most, and why? What is one thing I can do to support you?
- **How to help.** A calm place and time to study, early nights, and your interest. Praise effort and honesty more than marks.

رَبَّنَا هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ أَزْوَاجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّاتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعْيُنٍ وَاجْعَلْنَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا

"Our Lord, grant us from our spouses and offspring comfort to our eyes and make us a leader for the righteous."

Al-Furqān 25:74

Next month

Month 6: Money and Responsibility. Earn ḥalāl, spend wisely, save and give.

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Four sessions a week, one clear focus.

Clear speech opens doors in study, work and da'wah. This month you build the skills of listening, structuring ideas, using your voice, and speaking in front of others.

- Week 1: Foundations
- Week 2: Voice and body
- Week 3: Stories and persuasion
- Week 4: Practice
- A habit tracker, a month review and a page for parents

Join the Teenagers Building Circle

Deen, education, skills and personal development, live four times a week for ages 13 to 19.

himaayahschools.com/teenagers-building-circle